

I'M BORED WITH MY PLAYING!

FROM DIGGING DEEPER VIDEO #189

It happens to us all. We get bored of our playing, our vocabulary, and of everything that comes out of the instrument. It happened to Beethoven and Jimi Hendrix, to John Philip Sousa and to John Coltrane. It's human nature. The trick is to not quit, not give up, and not throw our saxophone out of the window (Charlie Parker, I'm talking to you). The trick is to work through it. But how? Where's the inspiration?

The next trick is to *not take too long*. If the solution to your boredom is to work on a lick or device that will take you a month just to get under your fingers, you've just signed up for another month of "blah." You need to get out of your plateau, and it needs to happen NOW.

Q: What is enlivening, powerful and easily within reach, today?

A: **Rhythm.**

#1 - Fungii Mama (Blue Mitchell)



#2 - Pent Up House (Sonny Rollins)



#3 - St. Thomas (Sonny Rollins)



#4 - Black Orpheus (first four bars)

